



## TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

# Botswana: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-17

Edition of 2026-08-18 • 99 systems and instruments tracked, 11 of them not held

*Compiled 2026-08-17 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections follow the status report. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.*

Of 99 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 41 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-17, 18 did not, 29 carry no stated baseline, and 11 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 156 sources for this place in the window — 39 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 117 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

**Movement values.** *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

## Summary of the period

The window's real movement is legislative. The [Digital Services Act](#) went from [passed-but-not-in-force](#) to [in force on 21 November 2025](#); the [Cybersecurity Act 2025](#) went from a [Bill](#) to [made and gazetted](#), and is still not in force; and the [Remote Service VAT Act](#) took effect on 1 June 2026 at 14% on non-resident digital services. The data-protection commission moved from [three contract officers with no premises](#) to [a commissioner in post enforcing against a government directorate](#).

Money moved the other way. Three digital development lines were cut for FY2026/27 — the [communications ministry ICT project](#) from P369,079,545 to P251,000,000, [research and development](#) from P477,403,718 to P213,700,000, and [basic education computerisation](#) from P270,000,000 to P253,000,000 — against FY2025/26 outturns of 38.7%, 9.0% and zero respectively.

Two operating positions worsened: [identity-card production](#) and [the listed operator's profit](#), down 45% to P146.2m.

# Infrastructure

## Connectivity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                         | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                 | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT          |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>MTC Namibia and BoFiNet cross-border fibre memorandum</b> | No agreement on file (2025-08)                                                                                                                | Covers cross-border fibre interconnection, capacity exchange, IP transit and the Buitepos-Ngoma corridor; no build, cost or date                                         | ADVANCED          |
| <b>Powertel-Paratus fibre corridor</b>                       | Public-private agreement signed June 2025, no route carrying traffic                                                                          | Phase 1 live at 800Gbps equipped on equipment rated over 10Tbps; phase 2 Bulawayo-Livingstone due September 2026                                                         | ADVANCED          |
| <b>BoFiNet internet gateway upgrade</b>                      | P100m upgrade complete: metro networks replaced in Gaborone and Francistown, London and Johannesburg exchange equipment upgraded (2025-04-16) | Unchanged; no further gateway investment on file at 2026-08-06                                                                                                           | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>BoFiNet Local Access Projects 2025/26</b>                 | Baseline not held                                                                                                                             | Completed at P43m, extending fibre to Moshupa, Ramotswa/Taung and Thamaga and connecting 191 customers — 68, 66 and 57 respectively — with 210 construction jobs created | BASELINE NOT HELD |
| <b>BTC rural satellite connectivity programme</b>            | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                                                                                             | 61 rural villages connected — schools, clinics and community centres — with 105 areas in process; no update on file since                                                | Baseline not held |
| <b>Internet penetration</b>                                  | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                                                                                             | 2.09m users, 81.4% penetration (end-2025)                                                                                                                                | Baseline not held |
| <b>National fibre network length</b>                         | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                                                                                             | About 16,000 km of fibre laid, linking South Africa, Namibia, Zimbabwe and Zambia                                                                                        | Baseline not held |
| <b>Village Connectivity Project</b>                          | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                                                                                             | Running; no site count, target, budget or completion date published                                                                                                      | Baseline not held |

## Data Storage

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                          | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                      | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Data-localisation amendment to the Data Protection Act</b> | No localisation amendment proposed on file (2025-08)                                               | A stated intention to compel businesses to store data in Botswana; no bill, draft or date on file at 2026-08-06                                    | ADVANCED |
| <b>Digital Delta Data Centre</b>                              | Built but not certified and not launched (2025-08)                                                 | In operation, Tier III certified and carrier-neutral, state-owned through BoFiNet, offering storage, hosting and exchange                          | ADVANCED |
| <b>Government migration to Digital Delta</b>                  | A stated intention to migrate services held at the shared digital services department (2025-11-25) | Critical government services migrated; no confirmation on file that the mid-2026 initial phase completed                                           | ADVANCED |
| <b>Kala Data Centre</b>                                       | First module delivered and under commissioning, generators en route, no revenue (2025-09-26)       | Fully commissioned; revenue described by the company as modest and at proof-of-concept scale; designed for up to 1MW, expansion subject to funding | ADVANCED |
| <b>Palapye solar data-centre campus</b>                       | No agreement on file (2025-08)                                                                     | Memorandum only, targeted at hyperscale and AI compute; no capacity, cost, site approval or timeline, and nothing on file since October 2025       | ADVANCED |

## Energy

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                   | AT 2025-08-01                                        | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT          |
|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Kala hybrid gas and solar generation   | Renewables named for future phases only (2025-09-26) | On-site gas-fired generation supplemented by solar, with battery and compressed-gas storage under review             | ADVANCED          |
| Lesedi 5MW solar development           | No solar development on file (2025-08)               | An initial 5MW assessed; no capital cost, approval or date                                                           | ADVANCED          |
| Palapye 250MW solar and storage        | Not on file (2025-08)                                | 250MW solar with a foreseen 100-400MW battery storage system; nothing on file since October 2025                     | ADVANCED          |
| Lesedi gas gathering network extension | BASELINE NOT HELD                                    | An extension to connect a further production well, subject to funding; it gates the data centre's capacity expansion | Baseline not held |

## Technical Capacity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT           | AT 2025-08-01                                           | AT 2026-08-17                                      | MOVEMENT  |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| International internet traffic | Just over 100Gbps (2025-02), up from under 8Gbps (2015) | Unchanged; no later figure published at 2026-08-06 | NO CHANGE |

## Cybersecurity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | AT 2025-08-01                             | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT          |
|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Liquid Secure360                                | Not offered in Botswana (2025-08)         | An integrated security framework and cloud services available to Botswana customers; no customer, revenue or capacity figures | ADVANCED          |
| National Cyber Drill                            | No national cyber drill on file (2025-08) | A four-day 2026 drill held; the base separately records an inaugural drill in the same season                                 | ADVANCED          |
| Cybercrime and Computer Related Crimes Act 2018 | In force (2025-08)                        | Still the operative cybercrime statute; its repeal is enacted but not commenced at 2026-08-06                                 | NO CHANGE         |
| Suspected digital fraud rate                    | BASELINE NOT HELD                         | 0.9% of consumer transaction attempts suspected digital fraud, the lowest of the African countries analysed                   | Baseline not held |

Data-centre capacity is where the year's building actually happened. The state facility went from **built but neither certified nor launched to in operation**, Tier III certified and carrier-neutral, with **critical government services migrated onto it** though no confirmation is on file that the mid-2026 initial phase completed. The commercial facility went from **a first module under commissioning with generators en route and no revenue**, to **fully commissioned at proof-of-concept revenue**, its on-site gas generation now **supplemented by solar**.

Two cross-border items advanced from nothing to paper. A **memorandum covering cross-border fibre interconnection, capacity exchange and IP transit** was signed with no build, cost or date; a solar data-centre campus at Palapye has had nothing on file since October 2025. The one physical delivery is the **first phase of a regional fibre corridor, live at 800Gbps**, whose live section is inside Zimbabwe.

Two measures did not move at all, and both matter. **International internet traffic** stands where it did in February 2025 at **just over 100Gbps**, the only national capacity figure the base holds; and the **P100m gateway upgrade completed in April 2025** has had no successor investment.

## Digital public infrastructure

### Data Exchange

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                               | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| SADC Agricultural Information Management System    | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Existing agricultural systems being assessed for integration; no integration date or committed systems held      | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| SADC cross-border DPI and federated eKYC framework | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Botswana named as one of sixteen participating states; no Botswana-specific integration step, pilot or date held | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

### Digital Identity and CRVS

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                       | AT 2025-08-01                                              | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT                 |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Electronic Identification System           | Prioritised for FY2025/26 as a partnership, not progressed | Rescoped to integrate digital identity, a national wallet and e-government services; a biometric identity card itemised at P31,700,000 in FY2026/27 | <b>STALLED, RESCOPED</b> |
| Omang card production and replacement      | Replacement operating without reported delay               | Delays running since the start of 2026; no backlog figure, no restoration date and no equipment-replacement commitment                              | <b>REGRESSED</b>         |
| Mandatory SIM registration                 | Mandatory for all users (2024-03)                          | Unchanged; no later regulator statement, registration rate or de-registration figure held                                                           | <b>NO CHANGE</b>         |
| National Public Key Infrastructure         | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                   | P423m secured, control transferred to the intelligence directorate, no working system, no timeline and no accountable owner                         | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| National Registration (Amendment) Act 2025 | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                   | In force; service providers reported to be refusing even the replacement receipt                                                                    | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

### Digital Payments and Fintech

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                | AT 2025-08-01                                            | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Instant cross-border payment corridor into Botswana | No live regional instant corridor into Botswana          | Live inbound from South Africa and Zimbabwe                                                                                   | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| Biometric grant payment cards                       | More than 75,000 beneficiaries and 1,200 shops (2025-05) | The same figure; no update in the twelve months                                                                               | <b>NO CHANGE</b>         |
| Citizen Wallet                                      | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                 | Announced as a unified wallet for subsidy delivery alongside a cryptographic card; no build, pilot, budget line or date since | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| National payment switch                             | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                 | Funded in plan only; no build, procurement, operator or date on the record                                                    | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

### Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT          | AT 2025-08-01                                      | AT 2026-08-17                                                                    | MOVEMENT        |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Electronic voter registration | No priced voter-register line in any held document | P50,000,000 appropriated within the commission's P336,870,640 development budget | <b>ADVANCED</b> |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                     | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                           | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                               | MOVEMENT          |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Deeds registry processing</b>                         | Substantially manual; workload 9,000 to 30,000 transactions a year since the 2017-18 land Acts, with no added resources | Unchanged; no digitisation programme, budget line or date on the record                                     | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>Elections Management System</b>                       | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                                | Built and in testing, replacing platforms developed in the 1990s; no supplier, cost or acceptance date held | Baseline not held |
| <b>Mandatory SMME registration and national database</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                                | Proposed only; no instrument, no penalties intended and no database in build                                | Baseline not held |

## Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                              | AT 2025-08-01                                                         | AT 2026-08-17                                                                  | MOVEMENT          |
|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Animal Disease Surveillance Dashboard</b>      | Did not exist                                                         | In operation, consolidating field data for national animal-health surveillance | ADVANCED          |
| <b>Government Accounting and Budgeting System</b> | Fully operational after the December 2024 fix, more than 20,000 users | Unchanged; no later statement, availability figure or upgrade held             | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>Labour Market Information System</b>           | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                              | Near completion; no go-live date, cost or supplier held                        | Baseline not held |

## Other GovTech and e-Gov

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                 | AT 2025-08-01                                     | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT  |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>1Gov-1Citizen platform</b>        | 33 e-services                                     | 52 e-services, including teacher registration, appointment scheduling and business facilitation                                 | ADVANCED  |
| <b>E-Payslip portal</b>              | Did not exist                                     | Offline with no reopening date; a privacy notice, an impact assessment, multi-factor authentication and disaster recovery added | REGRESSED |
| <b>National e-Procurement System</b> | Strategy approved 2025-06-17, no system operating | The same target date; the authority still states it has no real-time data on procurement transactions                           | NO CHANGE |

## National statistics

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                  | AT 2025-08-01                       | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                              | MOVEMENT          |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Statistician General</b>           | The post held in an acting capacity | A substantive statistician general in post; data quality described by a named analyst as worryingly uneven | ADVANCED          |
| <b>Africa Broadband Maps training</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>            | Training under way with Malawi, Zambia and Zimbabwe; no Botswana broadband map published                   | Baseline not held |

## Use of satellite data

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT | AT 2025-08-01                                                                 | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                          | MOVEMENT  |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>BOTSAT-1</b>      | In orbit, hyperspectral, with data commercialisation stated as the next phase | Unchanged; commercialisation still stated as the next phase, with no product, customer or revenue held | NO CHANGE |

Identity moved backwards on two measures and sideways on a third. Card replacement went from [operating without reported delay to delays running since the start of 2026](#), with no backlog figure or restoration date. The electronic identification system went from [prioritised for FY2025/26 as a public-private partnership and not progressed, to rescope](#)d, with a biometric identity card itemised at P31,700,000 in FY2026/27. Behind both, the public key infrastructure entered the record for the first time as [funded, begun, incomplete and non-operational](#).

Service delivery advanced on count and not on use: [e-services went from 33 to 52](#), with no usage figure at either end, while the [payroll portal was taken offline by the data-protection regulator](#) — the only Botswana government system the base records as suspended that way.

Two things acquired a price for the first time. The voter register went from [no priced line in any held document to P50,000,000 appropriated for FY2026/27](#) within the commission's P336,870,640 development budget, and a [cross-border instant payment corridor went live inbound from South Africa and Zimbabwe](#).

Four positions held exactly still: the [e-procurement system's beginning-of-2027 target](#), the [deeds registry's substantially manual processing](#), the [biometric grant cards at more than 75,000 beneficiaries](#), and [BOTSAT-1's commercialisation, still stated as the next phase](#) with no product, customer or revenue.

## Governance and regulation

### Legislation and regulation

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                     | AT 2025-08-01                                                                               | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT                                                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cybersecurity Act 2025                                   | Not enacted; a Bill only (2025-08)                                                          | Made and gazetted, not in force at 2026-08-06, the stated April 2026 commencement having passed                                                                                                                                                                  | ADVANCED, THE STATED APRIL 2026 COMMENCEMENT NOT ON RECORD |
| Digital Services Act                                     | Passed 2024, not in force; a standalone services agency publicly contested (2025-08-18)     | In force; the compliance clock runs to November 2027                                                                                                                                                                                                             | ADVANCED                                                   |
| Electronic Payment Services (Amendment) Regulations 2026 | Did not exist                                                                               | In operation; scope extended to money or value transfer services, fit-and-proper reaching beneficial owners and 10% shareholders, unlicensed operation punishable by P1,000,000 and five years                                                                   | ADVANCED                                                   |
| National Cybersecurity Authority                         | Did not exist (2025-08)                                                                     | Created in law with a board, chief executive, a licensing power over cybersecurity providers, a power to approve software before market placement and a critical-infrastructure mandate; not established, and no organisation or vote in the FY2026/27 estimates | ADVANCED                                                   |
| Remote Service VAT Act                                   | Announced, not in effect; the tax system described as built for tangible goods (2026-03-23) | In effect, with a stated collection target of about P450m a year                                                                                                                                                                                                 | ADVANCED                                                   |
| Virtual Asset Act 2022 and provider licensing            | Act in force, crypto not legal tender (2025-07)                                             | Act in force; the regional assessor still records provider-oversight shortcomings (2026-02)                                                                                                                                                                      | NO CHANGE                                                  |

## Strategies, plans and policies

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                 | AT 2025-08-01                                                          | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT          |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| National E-Waste Management Strategy | Did not exist                                                          | Strategy launched and an inter-agency memorandum signed; no targets, budget, collection volumes or implementation dates published                            | ADVANCED          |
| Digital Services Authority           | Under consideration and publicly contested as duplicative (2025-08-18) | Still announced only; nothing on record being built at 2026-08-06                                                                                            | NO CHANGE         |
| ICT Roadmap 2030                     | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                               | A blueprint targeting 100,000 ICT jobs within five years and a double-digit ICT share of GDP; its named priorities appear as projects in no estimates volume | Baseline not held |

## Regional collaboration

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                             | AT 2025-08-01                                         | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT                          |
|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Botswana-Namibia ICT memorandum of understanding | No bilateral ICT memorandum on file (2025-08)         | Announced for signature, extending roaming and submarine-cable transit cooperation to digital transformation, emerging technologies and cybersecurity; no term, funding, named workstream or data-governance provision published | ADVANCED, SIGNATURE NOT CONFIRMED |
| SADC One Network Area roaming                    | Botswana-Namibia reduced roaming rates only (2024-08) | Six SADC states; roaming cuts of between 10% and 98.6%, Botswana-Zambia data roaming down by up to 94%, incoming SMS free across participants                                                                                    | ADVANCED                          |
| SADC regional internet exchange host bid         | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                              | Shortlisted; no award decision on record in the eight months to 2026-08-06                                                                                                                                                       | Baseline not held                 |

## Standards

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                    | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                          | MOVEMENT          |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| ITU Radio Regulations Board candidature | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | A campaign under way with member-state lobbying; the election for the 2027-2030 term has not been held | Baseline not held |

## Data protection

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                                   | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                  | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Determination and enforcement notice against the public service management directorate | Did not exist                                                                                                  | Portal suspended; a privacy notice published 2026-07-06, an impact assessment completed 2026-07-13, multi-factor authentication and a disaster-recovery plan added; no reopening date | ADVANCED  |
| Information and Data Protection Commission                                             | Three contract officers, no premises, no published address, no website and no deputy commissioner (2025-07-29) | A commissioner in post, enforcing against non-bank financial institutions in February 2026 and against a government directorate in July 2026                                          | ADVANCED  |
| Data Protection Act No. 18 of 2024                                                     | In force, regulator not yet operational (2025-07-29)                                                           | In force; first published enforcement against a government body, 2026-07-17                                                                                                           | NO CHANGE |

## EU activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                               | AT 2025-08-01                            | AT 2026-08-17                                                        | MOVEMENT  |
|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| EU Cooperation Facility for digital transformation | EUR 1,500,000 committed, US\$0 disbursed | EUR 1,500,000 committed, US\$0 disbursed at the record's access date | NO CHANGE |

Three statutes changed state in the window. The [Digital Services Act](#) came into force with a compliance clock to November 2027; the [Cybersecurity Act 2025](#) was assented and gazetted and has not commenced, the stated April 2026 date having passed; and the [Electronic Payment Services \(Amendment\) Regulations 2026](#) came into operation, extending scope to money or value transfer services and making unlicensed operation punishable by P1,000,000 and five years. The [Remote Service VAT Act](#) moved from announced to in effect against a stated collection target of about P450m a year.

The institutions those statutes create did not follow. The [National Cybersecurity Authority](#) went from not existing to created in law with a board, a chief executive and a licensing power – and no organisation or vote in the FY2026/27 estimates; the [Digital Services Authority](#) is where it was, announced and contested.

The exception is the data-protection commission, which went from [three contract officers with no premises, published address, website or deputy commissioner](#) to a commissioner in post enforcing against non-bank financial institutions and then against a government directorate. Regionally, roaming went from [Botswana-Namibia reduced rates only to six SADC states, with cuts of between 10% and 98.6%](#).

## Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

### AI

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                           | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT          |
|------------------------------------------------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| AI adoption, chatbot visits per internet user  | BASELINE NOT HELD | 0 to 0.40 visits per user per month on a 0 to 2.6 scale, among the lowest adopters, in a band covering about 45% of Africa | Baseline not held |
| Judicial capability on AI and digital evidence | BASELINE NOT HELD | A commitment stated; no programme, budget, date or filing rollout on record                                                | Baseline not held |

### ICT Industry

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT   | AT 2025-08-01                                                | AT 2026-08-17                                       | MOVEMENT  |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| BTCL profit before tax | P266.6m for the year ended 2025-03-31, on revenue of P1.49bn | P146.2m, down 45%, on revenue of P1.47bn, down 1.6% | REGRESSED |

### Innovation ecosystem

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                        | AT 2025-08-01                                     | AT 2026-08-17                                        | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Research projects funded under the National Research Agenda | 45 projects approved in 2024, all carried forward | 45 projects, with no new projects added in FY2025/26 | NO CHANGE |



## US / hyperscaler activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT      | AT 2025-08-01   | AT 2026-08-17                                                                          | MOVEMENT |
|---------------------------|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Artemis Accords accession | Not a signatory | Signed as the 68th signatory, about fifteen months after the national satellite launch | ADVANCED |

## China activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT           | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT          |
|--------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Huawei ICT Academy in Botswana | BASELINE NOT HELD | Operating with five tertiary institutions; certifications in cloud, networking, data management and cybersecurity | Baseline not held |

## Gulf/UAE activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT         | AT 2025-08-01                                                                  | AT 2026-08-17                                                                               | MOVEMENT  |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Kala Data heads of agreement | Heads of agreement in place with the UAE counterparty, site planning under way | Unchanged; the UAE counterparty is not named in the operator's 2026-08-03 quarterly account | NO CHANGE |

Nothing in Botswana's AI position moved, because there is nothing to move: no national policy, strategy or regulatory instrument is held at either end of the window. What entered the record is one commitment — the [Judiciary's resolution to train judges in AI](#) — and one external measure of adoption.

The sector's measurable positions both regressed or stalled. The listed operator's [profit before tax fell 45% to P146.2m on revenue down 1.6% to P1.47bn](#), on company-reported figures. Research activity is unchanged for a second year: [45 projects carried forward, five completed and none added](#).

The one clear advance is diplomatic: Botswana went from [not a signatory to the 68th signatory of the Artemis Accords](#).

## Inclusion and capacity

### Digital divides

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                     | AT 2025-08-01                                                                 | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                  | MOVEMENT          |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| BTC Community Wi-Fi, Old Naledi                          | A single site, tariffs P2 to P10 plus a free 45-minute daily window (2025-06) | The same single site; no second site recorded to 2026-08-06                                    | NO CHANGE         |
| Universal Access and Service Fund school digital centres | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                             | P1.45m and P1.5m per site, thirty machines each; no programme total or school target published | Baseline not held |

### Access to services

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT             | AT 2025-08-01                                  | AT 2026-08-17                                                        | MOVEMENT  |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Mascom device-financing facility | Launched, no uptake figure published (2025-05) | Still no uptake, portfolio or default figure published at 2026-08-06 | NO CHANGE |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                   | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                     | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>BTC prepaid mobile data tariffs</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | 1.5GB a day for P10; 4GB a month for P65; 30GB over 30 days for P199; 100GB over 30 days for P349 | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Literacy

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                     | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-17                                     | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Regulator school ICT and cyber-awareness training</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Four schools reached; no national coverage figure | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Training and skills

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>ITU and CRASA geographic-information training</b>   | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Regulators from Botswana, Malawi, Zambia and Zimbabwe attending, under the Africa Broadband Maps project                             | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| <b>STEAM e-learning, coding and robotics programme</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | P654.4m awarded; the financial evaluation was received, adjudicated and approved the same day, and the decision published 2026-07-08 | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Research institutions

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                    | AT 2025-08-01                                                          | AT 2026-08-17                                                                              | MOVEMENT                               |
|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>National Research Agenda</b>                         | 45 projects approved in 2024; the agenda approved by Cabinet July 2025 | 45 projects carried forward, P9.5m spent in FY2025/26, five completed and none added       | <b>ADVANCED, NO NEW PROJECTS ADDED</b> |
| <b>University of Botswana virtual-reality programme</b> | Did not exist                                                          | The first local virtual-reality programme, giving remote access to university laboratories | <b>ADVANCED</b>                        |

Access instruments did not move. [Community Wi-Fi is still the single site it was](#), and the [device-financing facility has published no uptake, portfolio or default figure](#) in the twelve months since launch.

## Finance

### New investments

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                      | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT        |
|-------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Botswana Tech Fund</b>                 | Did not exist | A GBP 50m target with GBP 10m committed and a GBP 5m first close; tickets GBP 25,000 to 100,000 for the accelerator and GBP 0.5m to 2m for growth | <b>ADVANCED</b> |
| <b>Scalar Botswana Innovation Program</b> | Did not exist | A twelve-month programme for ten climate and digital startups, routed to a US\$150m decarbonisation fund                                          | <b>ADVANCED</b> |

### MoUs and other agreements

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                         | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT        |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Orange Botswana and special economic zones memorandum</b> | Did not exist | A framework for connected utilities, smart security, digital platforms and connectivity in special economic zones; no value stated | <b>ADVANCED</b> |

## Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                     | AT 2025-08-01                                                             | AT 2026-08-17                                                                         | MOVEMENT          |
|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Basic education ministry computerisation                 | P270,000,000 appropriated (FY2025/26), revised to P38,819,833, outturn P0 | P253,000,000 appropriated (FY2026/27)                                                 | REGRESSED         |
| Communications ministry ICT project                      | P369,079,545 appropriated (FY2025/26), outturn P142,712,599 at 38.7%      | P251,000,000 appropriated (FY2026/27)                                                 | REGRESSED         |
| Communications ministry research and development project | P477,403,718 appropriated (FY2025/26), outturn P42,771,544 at 9.0%        | P213,700,000 appropriated (FY2026/27)                                                 | REGRESSED         |
| Higher education ministry computerisation                | P3,950,000 appropriated (FY2025/26), fully spent                          | P16,000,000 appropriated (FY2026/27)                                                  | ADVANCED          |
| Shared Digital Services department recurrent vote        | P594,362,280 appropriated (FY2025/26)                                     | P587,310,850 appropriated (FY2026/27)                                                 | NO CHANGE         |
| Revenue service modernisation line                       | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                         | P4.13bn proposed for electronic invoicing, digital taxation and border infrastructure | Baseline not held |

The budget is where this window's clearest deltas sit, and four of five run down. Against FY2025/26 appropriations, FY2026/27 gives the [communications ministry ICT project P251,000,000](#) rather than [P369,079,545](#) — a third consecutive cut from [P736.6m](#) in FY2024/25 — [research and development P213,700,000](#) rather than [P477,403,718](#), and [basic education computerisation P253,000,000](#) rather than [P270,000,000](#) on a prior-year outturn of P0. The largest recurrent line is flat at [P587,310,850](#). Only higher education computerisation rose, from [P3,950,000](#) fully spent to [P16,000,000](#).

Private capital appeared where public capital withdrew. A [technology fund reached a GBP 5m first close](#) against a [GBP 50m target, with GBP 10m committed](#); a [twelve-month programme for ten climate and digital startups launched](#), routed to a [US\\$150m decarbonisation fund](#) with no Botswana-specific allocation stated; and a [memorandum on connectivity in special economic zones](#) was signed with no value.

## Where the record is thin

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                  | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                                                                                        | LAST PROBED    |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| National Cybersecurity Strategy                       | the strategy document itself, or a gazette notice or ministerial statement giving its date of adoption and version                                                          | not yet probed |
| National IPv6 transition plan                         | a regulator or ministry IPv6 transition plan with a target date, or a published IPv6 adoption percentage for Botswana                                                       | not yet probed |
| National open-data portal or policy                   | a named national open-data portal, a Cabinet-approved open-data policy, or a statistics-office dataset register with a publication date                                     | not yet probed |
| EU-Botswana digital cooperation instrument since 2022 | a named Global Gateway or development package for Botswana with a value and a signature date                                                                                | not yet probed |
| Local-government digital systems                      | a local-government ministry committee-of-supply speech naming council systems, or a named council-level rates, licensing or land-allocation platform with a dated statement | not yet probed |
| National AI policy or strategy                        | a gazetted national AI policy, or the development plan's AI policy project producing a published document                                                                   | not yet probed |
| India-Botswana technology or digital cooperation      | any India-Botswana memorandum, line of credit, training record or Indian vendor contract naming Botswana                                                                    | not yet probed |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                      | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                            | LAST PROBED    |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>Official internet penetration figure</b>               | the regulator's annual report, or a statistics-office household ICT access survey                               | not yet probed |
| <b>National digital literacy measure</b>                  | a dated statistics-office or regulator household ICT survey reporting a digital-literacy or digital-skills rate | not yet probed |
| <b>Universal fund annual allocation and school target</b> | the regulator's annual report, or the universal fund's own accounts                                             | not yet probed |
| <b>Audited outturn for digital budget lines</b>           | the Auditor General's report on the accounts of the Government of Botswana for FY2024/25 or FY2025/26           | not yet probed |

Eleven rows carry no position at either end. Four are instruments the state names without producing: no cybersecurity strategy, no AI policy or strategy, no IPv6 transition plan, no open-data portal or policy. Three are measures of the state's own delivery that nobody publishes: no official internet penetration figure — leaving a reference study and a regulator statement three weeks apart and unreconciled as the only readings — no national digital-literacy rate, and no universal-fund annual allocation or school target.

The remaining four are a whole layer and three relationships: nothing at all on district or council digital systems, no audited outturn for any digital budget line in any year, no named European Union instrument behind the assistance the minister described, and no India cooperation of any kind. The absence of an audited outturn is the one that bears hardest on this document, because every budget movement above is stated at appropriation stage. Each row is in `gaps.csv` with what would settle it; none has yet been probed on a date.

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## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EDITION         | <b>2026-08-18</b>                                                                                                                                                   |
| CURRENT EDITION | <a href="https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/BWA/BWA-progress.html">https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/BWA/BWA-progress.html</a>                     |
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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.